

Problem Chains

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Introduction

Welcome to 'Problem Chains', the fifth module in the Copywriting 101 course. In this module, we'll cover the psychology behind 'problems' and how we can use problems to position our product/service as irresistible to our target audience.

DISCLAIMER: I highly recommend watching every previous module BEFORE watching this module, as we'll be building on the concepts we learned there. If you don't understand those concepts in depth, applying the concepts you'll learn here will be harder and more complicated.

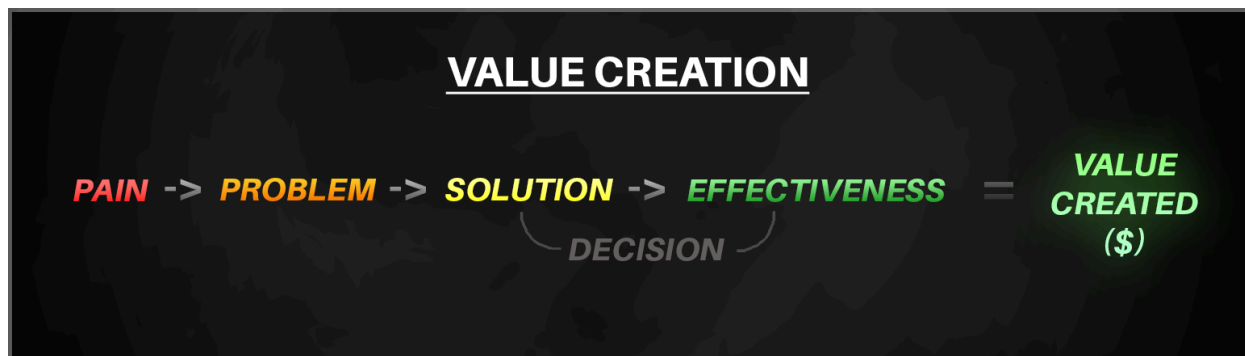
Link to the FULL video version: [Problem Chains Video](#)

Link to the mastersheet: [Copywriting Mastersheet](#)

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Value Creation

The ultimate goal of entrepreneurship is to create 'value' for our customers by solving their problems. That value we create is exchanged for their value in the form of money.



(More Value = More Money)

Step 1: Pain - If they're not in pain, they won't look for a problem that could be causing pain.

Step 2: Problem - If they don't connect their pain to a problem you solve, they'll never discover the solution you offer.

Step 3: Solution - If they don't believe that your solution is the best/only solution to that problem, they'll never choose your solution to solve their problem.

Step 3.5: Decision - If they don't believe they have to decide/buy right now, they'll procrastinate on making the decision. *(Usually finding another problem to blame their pain on, waiting until pain continues to increase, or they're forced with urgency/scarcity at a later date.)*

Step 4: Effectiveness - The amount of 'value created' is determined by how well you solve the problem, which alleviates their pain, OR how well the person 'thinks' your product/service solved their problem, which alleviates their pain.

(As you move up the hierarchy of needs, the effectiveness of your solution gets more and more subjective. EX: It's easy to tell if someone is no longer hungry, it's much harder to know when you've achieved true fulfillment.)

SOME MAJOR BREAKTHROUGHS AROUND 'VALUE'

(Most beginner entrepreneurs spend years stuck in place until they understand these.)

Breakthrough #1: 'Selling' your audience on the problem, then your solution, has to happen first — BEFORE the value can be created.

> *There were many times in my early years of entrepreneurship when I had 'life-changing' products/frameworks/advice that, when I launched/shared it, I got no sales/views/etc. My 'life-changing' advice changed no one's life. In the past year, there have been many times where I 'sold' my audience on the same advice BEFORE giving it to them, and this time it changed hundreds (maybe thousands) of lives.*

> *The saying 'build it and they will come' only applies if you have something truly EXTRAORDINARY. And to build something that good takes at least a decade and close to 100x more effort than we think. And to spend a decade on something, you need money to survive while you build... which requires you to sell in the meantime lol.*

> *For products/services that require substantial effort from the customer to get results, the 'sales process' IS the first step to the real value being created. (DIY, DWY offers)*

> *If you're coaching someone through a weight-loss journey, the more false beliefs you break during the sales process, the more 'sold' they are on your methods and their abilities to do those methods, (also the more money they spend upfront) the more likely they are to put in the work on their end, which creates the results — the value!*

Breakthrough #2: Value is created in the mind and depends on which core desire(s) the person/audience is currently trying to achieve. *(Beauty is in the eye of the beholder.) (There is no 'universal' set value for a product/service.)*

Value is relative.

> *If you tried to sell a famous Picasso painting in a remote African tribe marketplace. You'd probably only get a few pieces of fruit for it. If you were lucky, maybe a couple of bowls. But you certainly wouldn't get the \$50M the same painting would fetch if you sold it in New York City.*

The relativity of value is determined by which 'core desire' a person is trying to achieve in the hierarchy of needs. (See 'Pain-Confidence' module)

> *If you were dying of thirst in the desert for a week and someone had a gallon of water but you had to pay all your life savings in exchange, you'd do that in an instant, instead of dying.*

> *If someone is trying to solve the bottom tiers of core desires (ie: they're starving, need shelter, and endangered) they couldn't give a frick about a lamborghini, getting their picture taken with Tom Brady, or buying your LooksMaxxing Course.*

> *If someone is trying to solve the middle tiers of core desires (ie: they have low-status, don't have community, don't have a sexual companion, don't have time freedom), they won't care about spending all their time getting food/water/shelter, it's already been achieved. They'll also be less interested in finding 'true fulfillment' in life because they don't have the middle tiers of desires. Chances are, they'll be locked in 'chasing the bag.'*

> *If someone has more money & time than they know what to do with (they achieved the low/mid tiers), they'll be less interested in your 'GETTA BAG 101 COURSE' and more interested in enlightenment, self-actualization, purpose, legacy, maximizing status, etc. (This is why that Picasso painting is worth millions in NYC and not Africa.)*

> *Big Sean Example*

Breakthrough #3: What you sell doesn't have to be 'worth a million bucks,' it just has to be worth more/more valuable to the person who bought it than the money (*price*) they paid for it.

THIS IS ALSO WHY SELLING STUFF TO 'RICH' PEOPLE IS OVERPOWERED!!!

> *Since they have more money, each dollar is worth less to them. Money isn't scarce.*

> *They are more likely to be focused on the 'higher-tier' core desires, which are less-solvable by money (ex: having a billion dollars doesn't mean you automatically are fulfilled for the rest of your life), which means, money is inherently 'less-valuable' to them. (You can charge a higher price for the same solution.)*

It's all about expectations & which 'level' of life they're currently trying to beat.

> You can sell the same online course to two different people for the same price, one of them can find it extremely valuable (based on the pain/problem they're solving), while the other one can believe it wasn't valuable at all.

Same product/service, but different 'levels' of life, they're stuck on. It's like selling someone the 'cheat codes' to LVL 3 of a game when they haven't even beaten LVL 1.

This is why selling intangibles like 'info & coaching' gets such a bad reputation in this current era.

> People make claims on the front-end, charge huge prices based on those claims, but then their product/service doesn't live up to the claims and the price charged.

> Offer owners sell their product/service to anyone and everyone possible because 'they know their stuff is valuable', failing to realize that it's ONLY valuable to someone at a specific stage where they need the info being sold. (The LVL 3 cheat codes are most valuable to someone who, for the life of them, can't beat LVL 3)

Concrete 'Real-World' Example:

> If you sell a brand new MacBook Pro (something we'd all consider to be extremely valuable) to someone in a remote African tribe who doesn't have an internet connection or even electricity, it will barely be worth anything to them BECAUSE it doesn't solve any of the problems they're currently facing. (It's not even a good paperweight; they don't use paper!)

Does that mean the MacBook Pro as a product was a scam???? No lol.

You just sold it to someone who isn't currently trying to solve the problems that a MacBook Pro solves.

This is the problem with the online education space right now.

Focus on selling the 'cheat-codes' to the people who are stuck on that current level your 'cheat-codes' works for.

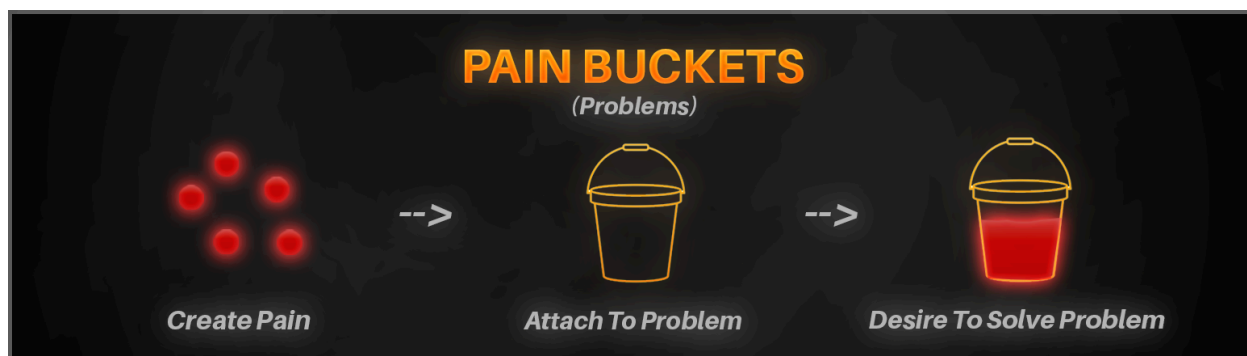
If there aren't many people on that level yet. Make free/lower-priced stuff that helps them beat the earlier levels and reach the level whereby they now NEED your main offer.

(Copy Elite Example, Russel Brunson Example)

Pain Buckets (Problems)

As we discussed in the previous module, our job as copywriters is to create pain and blame that pain on a specific problem that your product/solution solves.

You can view 'problems' as 'pain buckets' that people blame for being the cause of that pain.



The more pain you associate with a specific problem, the more pressure you feel to take action to solve that problem.

Examples From My Life:

> In middle school, I thought I wasn't getting girls because I had acne. (Core Desire: Sexual Companionship, Love, Belonging.) As my friends got gf's and I got rejected, my pain of not having a gf grew. I blamed that pain on my acne problem. As the pain grew, I became more willing to do ANYTHING to get rid of acne. (Turns out diet is the long-term fix and ACV does wonders short-term lol)

> In 9th grade, I wanted so badly to join a famous trickshotting team like FaZe, SoaR, etc. (Core Desire: Status, Respect, Belonging.) To join those teams, I needed to hit insane clips in the game. As the pain grew, I started buying anything I could to help me solve the problem of hitting better clips. I bought a Scuf controller, bought Kontrol Freeks, bought a better Xbox, etc.

> Two years ago, I wanted more than ever to make money online. (Core Desire: Freedom, Status, Purpose, Fulfillment) Every business I started failed, and I was looking for anything that would change that. (A problem to blame my pain on.) I started to notice multiple people talking about the importance of Copywriting. As I watched more videos and learned more about copywriting, I realized how important it was to EVERY aspect of online business. I started to blame all the pain of failed business/life/being broke on me not knowing copywriting. As the pain grew, I started doing whatever it took to learn this skill. Buying courses, reading books, practicing writing, etc. The rest is history.

For every problem you've tried to solve in your life, at some point, you've blamed the deep pain you felt on that problem, which led to you trying to solve it.

Your goal as a copywriter is to attach as MUCH pain as possible onto the specific problem/mechanism that your product/solution solves.

Examples:

> If I sell a speaking course, I'd show my audience how every pain in their life is because they don't know how to speak.

Can't get girls? If you have a warm, deep, confident voice, you could.
Can't get views? If you have a warm, deep, confident voice, you could.
Can't get a job? If you have a warm, deep, confident voice, you could.
Don't have friends? If you have a warm, deep, confident voice, you could.
People always interrupting you? If you have a warm, deep, confident voice, they wouldn't.

IMPORTANT: Those EXACT same pain points could be 'blamed' on a completely different problem. This is why copywriting is ESSENTIAL. Your product/service is not just competing against your niche's competitors. Your product/service is competing against every other possible solution to those same pain points.

***This is what most people don't realize with YouTube videos as well!

You MUST show them why the problem you solve is the true source of their pain.

> If I sold fitness coaching, I'd show my audience how every pain in their life is because they don't have an attractive physique.

Can't get girls? If you had a strong, attractive, confident body, you could.
Can't get views? If you had a strong, attractive, confident body, you could.
Can't get a job? If you had a strong, attractive, confident body, you could.
Don't have friends? If you had a strong, attractive, confident body, you could.
People always interrupting you? If you had a strong, attractive, confident body, they wouldn't.

As discussed in the last module, when the pain of doing nothing becomes unbearable, people do something. They take action. They 'tip' the bucket.

Unique Mechanisms

A unique mechanism is a specific, intriguing name for the specific problem that your solution solves.

By using effective unique mechanisms in your marketing, you create:

- > Curiosity/Intrigue
- > New/Only Emotion
- > Big/FOMO Emotion

Effective unique mechanisms are:

- > Specific
- > Unique
- > Casual
- > Simple

However, when used incorrectly, **unique mechanisms** can come across as 'salesy' and 'inauthentic.'
Personal Example:

> *High-Value Outreach VS. KJ's 4-Step 'Magic Bullet' Outreach Trick*

WARNING: These variables are 100% dependent on Specific Conditions! What sounds 'unique' to one audience could sound boring/overused to another. What sounds 'simple' to one audience might be too complex to another. Also, audiences and markets evolve and become more aware over time. Always keep the specific conditions of your audience in mind.

Examples of Successful Unique Mechanisms:

1. **Kinobody:** *'Intermittent Fasting'* to sell weight loss/muscle gain.
2. **Iman:** *'SMMA'* to sell the agency model/making money online.
3. **P90x:** *'Muscle Confusion'* to sell weight loss/muscle gain.
4. **Bulletproof Coffee:** *'Brain octane oil/MCT oil'* to sell their coffee.
5. **Clickfunnels:** *'Funnels'* to sell a website builder/making money online.
6. **True Classic Tees:** Using *'muscle fit'* (tight around chest and arms, loose around waist) to sell their t-shirts. ([Incredible Ad](#))

***Once again, it ALL depends on the specific conditions — which can change over a long enough time. Back in 2020, selling 'SMMA' and 'Dropshipping' was unique/shiny/exciting, but now in 2025, those unique mechanisms are falling flat. They're no longer unique. People are now using new mechanisms to sell the same agency module like 'Growth Operating', 'IPGA', etc.

***It doesn't have to be some crazy, complex-scientific thing. It's just a logical angle that makes your solution sound unique and exciting. (True Classic Tee)

Learning to **create compelling unique mechanisms** comes with **practice, iteration, and taste**. We'll go over plenty of examples to help you gain a better understanding of what makes a compelling mechanism, but it takes time. **Keep learning & practicing.**

Sub-Mechanisms

Things get even spicier when you introduce **sub-mechanisms** into your marketing.

Sub-mechanisms are unique mechanisms WITHIN your main mechanism that solve the 'micro-problems' involved in the process of achieving their desired results.

These **sub-mechanisms** are designed to **destroy limiting beliefs** that your audience has around the problem/opportunity/mechanism that you're selling.

For Example:

> When I was selling 'copywriting' as the unique mechanism to help people make money online. One of the biggest fears and micro-problems around copywriting is doing outreach. I created the sub-mechanism 'high-value outreach' to give hope/explain how you can get clients easily through the systems in Copy Elite. (because they take advantage of high-value outreach)

> This mechanism also provides a logical explanation for why their past attempts to do copywriting didn't work. They were sending 'low-value' outreaches. (Anti-mechanism) I also used 'long-form copywriting' as a sub-mechanism to explain how to get paid big money for copywriting, not just emails (short-form copywriting), which was the current failing trend.

> When Iman was selling SMMA as his unique mechanism, one of the biggest false beliefs was around the 'fulfillment' of the actual services. He created the sub-mechanism of 'the arbitrage economy' to explain how fulfillment is easy and you don't need to be skilled; you just hire someone overseas to do it.

To create effective sub-mechanisms, do the following:

1. Break down the result that your unique mechanism achieves into a simple 3-5 step process.

EX: Copywriting - Get good, get clients, get paid.

2. Make sure each step is targeted to break the biggest 'false beliefs' they have about your opportunity/themselves succeeding with the opportunity.

EX: Copywriting - takes too long to learn, outreach doesn't work/takes too many to send, I can't charge a lot of money for copy.

3. Use the same rules as creating a unique mechanism. Create a bunch until you find what sounds compelling.

EX: Copywriting - hyper-learning cycle, high-value outreach, long-form copy

Insane. Hopefully you see how powerful this crap is lol.

***Sub-mechanisms are not necessary in every single scenario. Neither is having a perfect unique mechanism. It differs across every product and every niche. Treat these as powerful tools in your copywriting/marketing toolbox. You might not always need it, but when you do, it's great to have.

Problem Chains

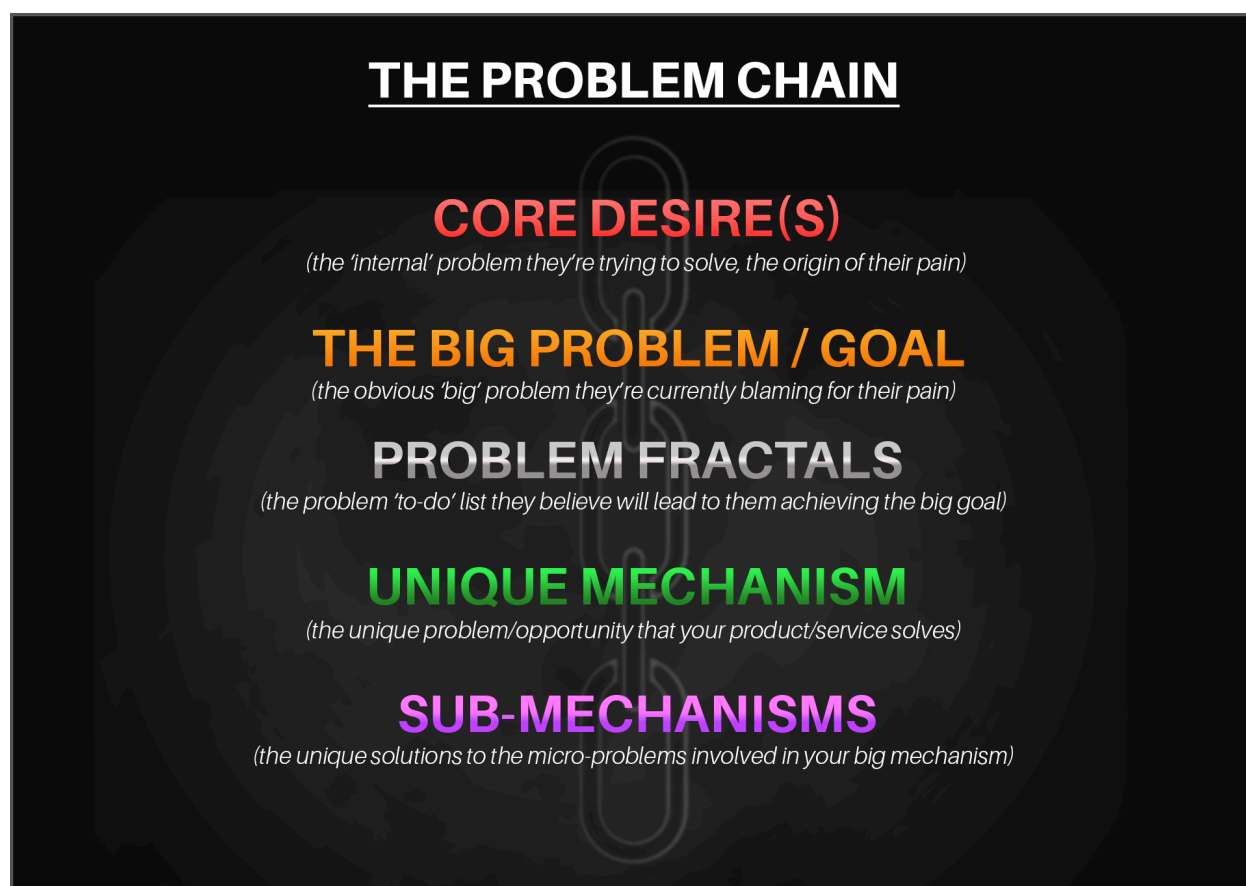
This is where things get exciting. Everything above led us to this section.

We solve big problems by breaking them into smaller problems. This is why we create 'processes' and 'to-do' lists.

Subconsciously, we form 'problem-chains' in our head that act as the usual subconscious 'to-do' list to achieve our goals (*what we think will fulfill our core desires*).

If you can prove how your unique mechanism (*the specific problem your product/service solves*) is the final domino that leads to them solving their bigger problems, they'll have an overwhelming urge to buy your thing.

We do this by mapping out the problem-chain that will logically lead your audience to the conclusion that they NEED your product/service.



1. What are the 'core desire(s)' that your audience is trying to fulfil?
 - a. See 'Pain-Confidence' module.
 - b. The internal problems, usually unaware of but are the real source of pain.
2. What is the 'obvious' external problem they currently blame they're pain on?
 - a. What is their big goal?
 - b. This could also be described as their current awareness level.
 - c. EX: Make money. Lose weight. Etc.
3. What is the unique mechanism / specific problem that your product/service solves?

- a. *Remember: Specific, Unique, Casual, Simple*
4. What is the logical chain of problems that someone would take in order to go from the obvious external problem to needing your unique mechanism?
 - a. *What are the increasingly specific problems that lead them to the conclusion of needing your unique mechanism/specific problem?*
 - b. *The fractals of problems that get more and more specific.*
5. What are the sub-mechanisms you can create to fall under your unique mechanism?
 - a. *Follow the steps outlined above.*
6. Important Reminders
 - a. *Keep it simple. What makes the most logical sense to reach the conclusion?*
 - b. *It takes practice. The important part is that you can now SEE why you buy things, why people buy things, and you can start noticing it everywhere. We'll cover tons of examples.*
 - c. *It takes time. The more time you spend thinking about the problem chain for what you sell, the more discoveries you will make.*

Nailing the **problem chain** will give you **EXTREME** clarity around your entire marketing effort. It's worth every hour you spend on it.

WARNING: THERE IS NO 'PERFECT' PROBLEM CHAIN. THERE IS NO 'RIGHT ANSWER'. THERE ARE MANY ANGLES/PATHS TO SELL SOMETHING. THE MAIN POINT HERE IS TO FIND A PATH THAT IS COMPELLING TO YOUR SPECIFIC CONDITIONS!

Reminder: It can be very easy to start 'overthinking' this like crazy. DON'T DO THAT. You'll discover/refine the best problem chain for your offer over time. Just keep taking action and let your subconscious cook on the problem chain. It'll come.

Mastering Problem Chains

Like usual, for these concepts to translate into **more money in your bank account**, you need to truly understand and apply them.



Let's cover how you can learn problem chains using the **hyper-learning cycle**:

1. **DO**: Practice daily by mapping out the problem chain for something you've bought recently or are thinking about buying. Get creative. Don't just stay in the 'info-product' niche. Map out a chain for literally everything.

Use this 'problem chain' section on your **Conditions Deck [TEMPLATE]** to map out chains.

2. **LEARN**: Re-watch this module and the previous ones.

3. **STUDY**: Study these [examples](#). Break down the problem chains of successful offers of people/products you want to write for.

4. **ITERATE**: Use what you learn from watching and studying to improve/refine the problem chains you create.

Let's do a 'study' cycle together live.

Like everything we've discussed, this takes practice. But once you learn how to create simple and compelling problem chains, your marketing will become **DANGEROUSLY** effective.

You'll unlock the ability to emotionally and logically sell them with ease. Congrats.

Quick Reminder:

If you want me to crank more modules like this one, and even better, let me know any wins/breakthroughs/thoughts you have on this module/course in the #🌟course-wins channel in the Discord. It gives me so much energy to know all the pain I go through making these is worth it haha. Love y'all and see you in the next module. ❤️ - KJ

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